

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Title: Puppy and Kitten Intake, Testing, and Quarantine Protocol

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Approved By: [Insert Name/Title]

Purpose

To establish consistent procedures for the intake, housing, testing, and management of puppies and kittens to prevent the spread of parvovirus and panleukopenia within the shelter.

Scope

This SOP applies to all staff and volunteers involved in the intake, housing, care, and cleaning of puppies and kittens.

Procedure

1. Puppy Intake and Housing

- Upon intake, all puppies should be housed in the **general dog population**, spread out among adult dogs when possible to avoid clustering.
 - **Do not house puppies together** or in close proximity to other unvaccinated puppies.
 - Each puppy's housing and health status should be monitored closely for signs of illness.
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2. Puppy Parvovirus Testing and Response

- Puppies should **only be tested for parvovirus** if they show **clinical symptoms**, including:
 - Diarrhea (with or without blood)
 - Vomiting
 - Lethargy or depression

- Asymptomatic puppies should **not** be tested.
 - If a puppy tests **positive for parvovirus** or is highly suspect based on clinical signs, the **medical team must be contacted immediately** to determine whether **euthanasia or other medical treatment** is appropriate.
 - Affected areas must be **cleaned and disinfected** with an approved parvovirus-effective disinfectant.
 - **Quarantine holds** will be set at **7 days** for any animals deemed exposed or requiring observation.
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3. Kitten Intake and Housing

- Kittens should be housed **together by age group** to maintain appropriate socialization and care levels.
 - **Kittens under 2 lbs** will be placed in the **kitten nursery** together for close monitoring and supportive care.
 - Staff must use **proper PPE**, including **changing gloves between cages** and using disinfectant on hands and equipment between litters.
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4. Kitten Testing and Response

- Kittens showing **clinical signs** such as **vomiting, diarrhea, or lethargy** should be tested for **feline panleukopenia (feline parvovirus)**.
 - If a kitten tests **positive for panleukopenia**, the **medical team will determine** the appropriate course of action—**euthanasia vs. treatment/other management**.
 - Exposed areas and equipment must be **thoroughly disinfected** using panleukopenia-effective agents.
 - **Quarantine holds** for exposed or at-risk kittens will also be **7 days**.
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5. PPE and Biosecurity

- Always **change gloves between cages or litters**.

- Wash or sanitize hands thoroughly after handling each animal.
 - Use designated cleaning supplies and tools for quarantine or sick areas —**do not share between general population and isolation.**
 - Dispose of contaminated materials appropriately.
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6. Documentation

- All testing, results, treatments, euthanasia decisions, and quarantine actions must be documented in the animal's record and shelter management system.